

Lesson 8: The Restoration of the Priesthood

Purpose: To increase our appreciation for the restoration of the priesthood, to encourage brethren to magnify their offices and callings in the priesthood, and to help each of us enjoy more fully the blessings of the priesthood.

1. Definition and purpose of the priesthood

WHAT IS THE PRIESTHOOD?

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO HAVE THE PRIESTHOOD ON THE EARTH?

HOW HAVE YOU BEEN BLESSED THROUGH THE SERVICE OF PRIESTHOOD HOLDERS?

WHAT INFLUENCE HAS THE PRIESTHOOD HAD ON YOU?

HOW HAVE YOU SEEN THE POWER OF THE PRIESTHOOD MANIFESTED IN YOUR LIFE?

HOW HAS THE PRIESTHOOD BLESSED AND STRENGTHENED YOUR FAMILY?

HOW CAN YOU MAKE THE INFLUENCE AND POWER OF THE PRIESTHOOD MORE EFFECTIVE IN YOUR LIFE?
IN YOUR FAMILY'S LIFE?

2. The restoration of the Aaronic priesthood

Joseph Smith—History 1:68-72; D&C 13; 84:26-27; 107:20

The keys of the ministering of angels (D&C 13; 84:26; 107:20)

President Gordon B. Hinckley: "That means, as I interpret it, that if you live worthy of the priesthood, you have the right to receive and enjoy the very power of heavenly beings to guide you, to protect you, to bless you." (Ensign, Nov. 1982, 45)

↪ President Wilford Woodruff

↪ Oscar W. McConkie

↪ Elder James M. Paramore's friend.

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: Ministering angels "can also be unseen. Angelic messages can be delivered by a voice or merely by thoughts or feelings communicated to the mind.... Most angelic communications are felt or heard rather than seen." (Ensign, Nov. 1998, 39)

Moroni 7:35-37

The keys of repentance and baptism (D&C 13; 84:26-27; 107:20)

↪ Elder Dallin H. Oaks

↪ Elder Jeffrey R. Holland

3 Nephi 7:18; 17:23-24; Moroni 7:25, 29-31; D&C 84:88.

3. The restoration of the Melchizedek Priesthood

D&C 27:23-13; 84:19-22; 107:1-12, 18-19

An account of this experience is not included in the Doctrine and Covenants, but references to it can be found in the heading to D&C 13; D&C 27:12-13; D&C 128:20; and *Our Heritage*, page 14.

WHAT AUTHORITY AND BLESSINGS WERE RESTORED WITH THE MELCHIZEDEK PRIESTHOOD?

Authority to administer the gospel of Jesus Christ (D&C 84:19)

"The keys of all the spiritual blessings of the church" (D&C 107:18)

Knowledge of the mysteries of the kingdom and knowledge of God (D&C 84:19; 107:19)

The power of godliness, which is manifested through the ordinances of the gospel (D&C 84:20-21)

The opportunity to see, commune with, and enjoy the presence of God the Father and His Son, Jesus Christ (D&C 84:22; 107:19)

The right of presidency (D&C 107:8-9)

The keys of the gathering of Israel, the gospel of the dispensation of Abraham, and the sealing power (D&C 110:11-16)

↪ Prophet Joseph Smith

↪ Lesson Manual

↪ Prophet Joseph Smith

↪ Joseph F. Smith

4. Blessings of the Priesthood for all people

HOW ARE WOMEN BLESSED BY THE PRIESTHOOD?

HOW ARE CHILDREN BLESSED BY THE PRIESTHOOD?

HOW ARE THOSE WITHOUT FAITHFUL PRIESTHOOD HOLDERS IN THEIR HOMES RECEIVE THE BLESSINGS OF THE PRIESTHOOD?

↪ *Next Week: Lesson 9: "The Only True and Living Church"*

President Wilford Woodruff: “I had the administration of angels while holding the office of a priest. I had visions and revelations. I traveled thousands of miles. I baptized men, though I could not confirm them because I had not the authority to do it.

“I speak of these things to show that a man should not be ashamed of any portion of the priesthood.” (*Discourses of Wilford Woodruff*, 298)

Oscar W. McConkie: “The administration of angels need not be as dramatic as were those of the restoring agents from on high. Angels may minister and the recipient need not know the source of his strength or joy. For example, one person may be helped while speaking from the pulpit, while another may receive guidance at a critical junction in his life. In some instances a third party has been aware of the presence of angels while the party actually concerned was apparently unaware of their presence.” (*Aaronic Priesthood*, 101)

Elder James M. Paramore had a friend in Alaska who didn’t know how to build a two-story home. He had an instruction book for one-story homes and some experience, but he had no idea how to add the second story. At the site he pleaded with Heavenly Father to teach him how.

As he prayed, he felt the presence of another person. He looked, saw no one, but continued to feel the presence of that person who then said, “If you’ll be quiet, I’ll tell you how to build your home. I’m a builder from Utah and Heavenly Father sent me here to help you build your home.”

This builder from Utah worked with Elder Paramore’s friend for the space of the whole day and at the end of the day said, “That’s all you need from me. I need to be going. I have some other assignments to fill.” (Elder James M. Paramore, Stake Conference Talk “A Church of Miracles,” Monterey Stake Conference, 29 Sep 1985)

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “Through the Aaronic Priesthood ordinances of baptism and the sacrament, we are cleansed of our sins and promised that if we keep our covenants we will always have His Spirit to be with us. I believe that promise not only refers to the Holy Ghost but also to the ministering of angels, for ‘angels speak by the power of the Holy Ghost; wherefore, they speak the words of Christ’ (2 Nephi 32:3). So it is that those who hold the Aaronic Priesthood open the door for all Church members who worthily partake of the sacrament to enjoy the companionship of the Spirit of the Lord and the ministering of angels.” (*Ensign*, Nov. 1998, 39)

Elder Jeffrey R. Holland: “We ask you young men of the Aaronic Priesthood to prepare and bless and pass these emblems of the Savior’s sacrifice worthily and reverently. What a stunning privilege and sacred trust given at such a remarkably young age! I can think of no higher compliment heaven could pay you. We do love you. Live your best and look your best when you participate in the sacrament of the Lord’s Supper.” (*Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 68)

The Prophet Joseph Smith: The “Melchizedek Priesthood ... is the channel through which all knowledge, doctrine, the plan of salvation and every important matter is revealed from heaven.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 166-167)

Lesson Manual: “The priesthood is the eternal power and authority of God. It is the power by which He created and governs the heavens and the earth. It is also the power by which He redeems and exalts His children. He gives a portion of His priesthood power and authority to worthy male members of the Church so they can preach the gospel, administer the ordinances of salvation, and govern His kingdom on earth.”

The Prophet Joseph Smith: “After a person has faith in Christ, repents of his sins, and is baptized for the remission of his sins and receives the Holy Ghost, (by the laying on of hands), which is the first Comforter, then let him continue to humble himself before God, hungering and thirsting after righteousness, and living by every word of God, and the Lord will soon say unto him, Son, thou shalt be exalted.

“When the Lord has thoroughly proved him, and finds that the man is determined to serve Him at all hazards, then the man will find his calling and his election made sure, then it will be his privilege to receive the other Comforter, which the Lord hath promised the Saints, as is recorded in the testimony of St. John, in the 14th chapter, from the 12th to the 27th verses.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 150)”

Joseph F. Smith: “The keys of the kingdom of God on earth are held by the apostles. The president of the church, who is the senior apostle, holds all the keys presently on earth and presides over all the organizational and ordinance work of the Church (D&C 107:8-9, 91-92). He delegates authority by giving the keys of specific offices to others (D&C 124:123). Only presiding priesthood officers (including General Authorities, stake presidents, mission presidents, temple presidents, bishops, branch presidents, and quorum presidents) hold keys pertaining to their respective offices. Latter-day Saints distinguish between holding the priesthood and holding keys to direct the work of the priesthood: one does not receive additional priesthood when one is given keys.” (*Improvement Era*, 4 [Jan. 1901]:230; or *Encyclopedia of Mormon-ism*, 780)